

LEI GIOIA YANG

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Research interests

Theoretical quantum matter; quantum information; mathematical physics; quantum phases of matter; strongly interacting many-body systems; properties of many-body Hamiltonians and states; entanglement measures; quantum anomalies; quantum many-body scars; topological semimetals; chiral fermions; crystalline defects; quantum circuit lower bounds; quantum state preparation; quantum simulation.

Education and work

2026 - current	Postdoctoral Fellow , <i>University of Boulder Colorado, USA.</i>
2023 - 2026	Burke Postdoctoral Fellow , Sherman Fairchild Postdoctoral Scholar Research Associate in Theoretical Physics (100% Research), <i>California Institute of Technology, USA.</i>
2023 (10th October)	PhD in physics , <i>University of Waterloo & Perimeter Institute, Canada.</i>
2018	MSc in physics , Perimeter Scholars International program, <i>University of Waterloo & Perimeter Institute, Canada.</i>
2017	MSc in physics , <i>Victoria University of Wellington, New Zealand.</i>
2015	BSc (Hons) in mathematics and physics , <i>Victoria University of Wellington, New Zealand.</i>

Upcoming appointment

2027 - onwards	Assistant Professor , Department of Physics and Astronomy, <i>Tufts University, Boston USA.</i>
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Awards and competitive funding

2023	Burke Postdoctoral Fellowship , <i>California Institute of Technology, USA.</i>
2023	KITP Graduate Fellowship , <i>Kavli Institute for Theoretical Physics, USA.</i>
2019	Vanier Canada Graduate Scholarship , <i>Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada (NSERC), Canada, National institutionally nominated doctoral scholarship; CAD 150,000.</i>
2019	President's Graduate Scholarship , <i>University of Waterloo, Canada; CAD 30,000.</i>
2017	Perimeter Scholars International , <i>Perimeter Institute/University of Waterloo, Canada Fully-funded MSc scholarship; CAD 45,000.</i>

Published or accepted papers

Note: In reverse-chronological order. I publish under the name Lei Gioia.

- ▶ **Lei Gioia**, Anton A. Burkov, and Taylor L. Hughes, *No-go theorem for single time-reversal invariant symmetry-protected Dirac fermions in 3+1d*, accepted for publication in *Physical Review B* (2026), DOI: [10.1103/g4h4-kb3c](https://doi.org/10.1103/g4h4-kb3c)
- ▶ **Lei Gioia** and Ryan Thorngren, *Exact Chiral Symmetries of 3+1D Hamiltonian Lattice Fermions*, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **136** (2026), DOI: [10.1103/s5q2-317m](https://doi.org/10.1103/s5q2-317m)
- ▶ Julian May-Mann, Mark R. Hirsbrunner, **Lei Gioia**, Taylor L. Hughes, *Crystalline axion electrodynamics in charge-ordered Dirac semimetals*, *Phys. Rev. B* **110** (2024), DOI: [10.1103/PhysRevB.110.155110](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevB.110.155110)
- ▶ Jinmin Yi, Xuzhe Ying, **Lei Gioia**, and A. A. Burkov, *Topological order in interacting semimetals*, *Phys. Rev. B* **107** (2023), DOI: [10.1103/PhysRevB.107.115147](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevB.107.115147)
- ▶ **Lei Gioia** and Chong Wang, *Non-zero momentum requires long-range entanglement*, *Phys. Rev. X* **12** (2022), DOI: [10.1103/PhysRevX.12.031007](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevX.12.031007)
- ▶ **Lei Gioia**, Chong Wang, and A. A. Burkov, *Unquantized anomalies in topological semimetals*, *Phys. Rev. Research* **3** (2021), DOI: [10.1103/PhysRevResearch.3.043067](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevResearch.3.043067)
- ▶ Chong Wang, **Lei Gioia**, and A. A. Burkov, *Fractional Quantum Hall Effect in Weyl Semimetals*, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **124** (2020), DOI: [10.1103/PhysRevLett.124.096603](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevLett.124.096603)
- ▶ **Lei Gioia**, M. G. Christie, U. Zülicke, M. Governale, and A. J. Sneyd, *Spherical topological insulator nanoparticles: Quantum size effects and optical transitions*, *Phys. Rev. B* **100** (2019), DOI: [10.1103/PhysRevB.100.205417](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevB.100.205417)
- ▶ **Lei Gioia**, U. Zülicke, M. Governale, and R. Winkler, *Dirac electrons in quantum rings*, *Phys. Rev. B* **97** (2018), DOI: [10.1103/PhysRevB.97.205421](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevB.97.205421)

Preprints

- ▶ Ryan Thorngren, **Lei Gioia**, and Carolyn Zhang, *Translation symmetry-enforced long-range entanglement in mixed states*, [arXiv:2605.15200](https://arxiv.org/abs/2605.15200) (2026) (in PRL review)*
- ▶ Nicholas O'Dea, **Lei Gioia**, Sanjay Moudgalya, and Olexei I. Motrunich, *Locality forces equal energy spacing of quantum many-body scar towers*, [arXiv:2601.14206](https://arxiv.org/abs/2601.14206) (2026) (in PRX Quantum review)*
- ▶ **Lei Gioia**, Sanjay Moudgalya, and Olexei I. Motrunich, *Distinct Types of Parent Hamiltonians for Quantum States: Insights from the W State as a Quantum Many-Body Scar*, [arXiv:2510.24713](https://arxiv.org/abs/2510.24713) (2025) (in PRB review)*
- ▶ **Lei Gioia** and Ryan Thorngren, *W State is not the unique ground state of any local Hamiltonian*, [arXiv:2310.10716](https://arxiv.org/abs/2310.10716) (2023) (in PRL review)*

Dissertations

- 2023 **PhD thesis**, L. Yang, *Interactions, Entanglement, and Anomalies in Topological Semimetals*, University of Waterloo, [URL](#).
- 2018 **MSc thesis**, L. Yang, *Quantum anomalies in Type I Dirac semimetals*, University of Waterloo.
- 2017 **MSc thesis**, L. Yang, *Quantum confinement of chiral charge carriers in ring conductors*, Victoria University of Wellington, [URL](#).

Selected Presentations

- 2026 **Workshop talk**, “Exact Chiral Symmetries of 3+1D Hamiltonian Lattice Fermions”, YITP: Frontiers of Lattice Fermions, *Kyoto University, Japan*
- 2026 **Physics colloquium**, “Renormalization, symmetries, and anomalies: Organizing principles for entangled quantum matter”, *Tufts University, Boston*
- 2026 **Physics colloquium**, “A window into quantum matter: the renormalization group view”, *New York University, New York*
- 2025 **Blackboard talk**, “Exact chiral symmetries on the lattice”, Lattice QCD talk, *Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Boston*
- 2025 **Condensed matter seminar**, “Distinct Types of Parent Hamiltonians for Quantum States”, *Boston University, Boston*
- 2025 **Talk**, “W State as a many-body quantum scar”, IQIM annual retreat, *IQIM & Caltech, Lake Arrowhead*
- 2025 **Workshop talk**, “The RG map: a window into gapless states”, Simons Foundation: Ultra Quantum Matter meeting, *University of Chicago, Chicago*
- 2024 **Workshop talk**, “W-state is not the unique ground state of any local Hamiltonian”, C*-Algebraic Quantum Mechanics and Topological Phases of Matter workshop, *University of Colorado Boulder, Colorado*
- 2023 **Quantum information seminar**, “W-state is not the unique ground state of any local Hamiltonian”, *Max-Planck of Quantum Optics, Munich*
- 2023 **Condensed matter seminar**, “Momentum creates long-range entanglement and quantum anomalies”, *University of California Berkeley, Berkeley*
- 2023 **Condensed matter seminar**, “Momentum creates long-range entanglement and quantum anomalies”, *University of California Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz*
- 2022 **Condensed matter seminar**, “Momentum creates long-range entanglement and quantum anomalies”, *University of Zurich, Zurich*
- 2022 **Blackboard seminar**, “Non-zero momentum requires long-range entanglement”, *Kavli Institute for Theoretical Physics, Santa Barbara*

2022	Condensed matter seminar , “Momentum creates long-range entanglement and quantum anomalies”, <i>California Institute of Technology, Pasadena</i>
2022	Condensed matter seminar , Institute for Condensed Matter Theory, “Momentum creates long-range entanglement and quantum anomalies”, <i>University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign</i>

Teaching and supervision

2022	Research project supervisor , PSI Winter School , <i>Machine learning social dynamics in physics</i> , One week supervision of two students in understanding the dynamics of physicists, their research, and their publishing behaviors.
2012 – 2017	Laboratory and tutorial demonstrator; outreach demonstrator , <i>School of Chemical and Physical Sciences</i> , Victoria University of Wellington, NZ Demonstrated and tutored for courses: ▸ Phys 114 - Physics 1A ▸ Phys 115 - Physics 1B ▸ Phys 221 - Relativity and Quantum Physics ▸ Phys 223 - Classical Physics ▸ Phys 309 - Solid State & Nuclear Physics

Academic services

2025 - current	Committee member , IQIM seminar series , Helped administer a USD 40,000 speaker budget and host researchers, <i>Institute of Quantum Information and Matter (IQIM) & Caltech</i> .
2020 - 2021	Committee member , Internal Strategic Planning Committee , <i>Perimeter Institute for Theoretical Physics</i> .
2019 - 2021	Committee chair , Ph.D. student committee, Elected, Represented graduate students and helped establish a peer-mentoring programme, <i>Perimeter Institute for Theoretical Physics</i> .
2019 - 2021	Committee member , Respectful Environment working group, Co-authored the Respectful Environment code of conduct , <i>Perimeter Institute for Theoretical Physics</i> .
2019	Event organizer , FemPhys mentoring event , organised an event with 20 female mentors & 50 mentees, <i>Perimeter Institute for Theoretical Physics</i> .